



6 Interactive skills: the individual oral

Interactive skills · IB Diploma · Concept guide and original exam-style practice

Understand the concept

The individual oral assesses interactive and productive speaking skills: candidates are given a photograph or visual stimulus linked to one of the five prescribed themes, prepare a short presentation connecting the image to the theme and to their own experience or culture, then take part in a follow-up discussion with the examiner. Success depends on going beyond simple description to interpretation, and on responding flexibly and in depth during the conversation rather than relying on memorised scripts.

Worked example: follow the reasoning

Sample opening line for a photo of a crowded recycling point: 'This image shows people queuing to recycle at a communal point, which connects to the theme of sharing the planet because it raises the question of individual responsibility versus community infrastructure for environmental action.'

Quick check · multiple choice

What is the biggest risk of memorising a full script for the individual oral presentation?

- A It improves pronunciation
- B It reduces spontaneity and can sound unnatural or fail if the examiner asks unexpected questions
- C It is not allowed to use any notes at all
- D It automatically lowers the theme relevance

Write your choice: _____

Structured practice

Answer in the space provided.

- 1 Individual oral task: you are shown a photograph of an elderly and a young person using a smartphone together at a kitchen table. Prepare a two-minute spoken presentation connecting this image to the theme of identities or human ingenuity, then be ready to answer three follow-up questions from the examiner about generational differences in technology use. [30]

Final answer: _____



Answers and explanation

Question 1 [30]

A strong spoken response includes:

- A brief description of the image used only as a springboard, not the main content
- A clear link to the chosen theme, such as how technology use shapes identity across generations, or ingenuity in bridging generational gaps
- Development with specific, personal or cultural examples, such as a grandparent learning video calls
- A concluding remark connecting back to the theme's wider significance
- In the follow-up discussion: answers that extend beyond one sentence, ask for clarification when needed, and engage genuinely with the examiner's questions rather than repeating the presentation
- Accurate, varied language with natural pacing rather than a memorised, monotone delivery

Quick check answer

B. Memorised scripts often sound unnatural and leave candidates unprepared for the spontaneous follow-up discussion.

Self-assessment

Compare each credited step with your own answer. Fix the first reasoning or content error, then retry the practice question without looking at the solution.

Based on the IB English B guide (2018).

Original FagusED teaching material. Not an official IB publication; the sample scenarios and language are invented and generic.